

BOY NEXT DOOR
IMRAN KHAN, 25

Played princeling with pedigree but no paisa in *Jaane Tu Ya Jaane Na*. Next, a boy who abducts his love interest in *Kidnap*.

WE SAY Let's see him in a film not promoted by hit-guarantor Aamir Khan



THE BUBBLEGUM BOYS

FAMILY MATTERS
RANBIR KAPOOR, 26

Failed when forced to clone his grandfather in *Saawariya*. Is now ready to copy his father, complete with his emblematic song, in *Bachna Ae Haseenon*.

WE SAY Just be yourself



■ By Kaveree Bamzai

Lucky boy, you're my lucky boy/jaane kaun banega mera lucky boy'. These intelligent words come from a song in the forthcoming *Bachna Ae Haseenon*, which seems to have been constructed in the marketing department of an EMCG behemoth. Three girls, one, a small town innocent, two, a Shiamak Davar dancer and, three, an NRI from Australia, all in love with one desirable Punjabi munda,

with a new age profession—he's a gaming expert. With all songs having dollops of indecipherable Punjabi phrases, and every girl's costume having been put together by Aki Narula from previous Yash Raj Films, it could be the coronation of a new prince, Ranbir Kapoor.

Or not. Audiences have just been treated to another Punjabi munda, all big hair, lip gloss, fake tan and eyeliner, Harman Baweja, who was also alluringly sung to by Priyanka Chopra ('Hey you loverboy/will you be my toy?'). Baweja's Rs 60-crore debut, *Love Story 2050*, looked like the dream launch on paper. Two Priyanka Chopras (she has a double role), an opening shot that has

him in an MG and racing like a speed-demon, a talking glove named Widdie-winks and a robot named Q.T. (read cutie). Added to this, are special effects, mountain biking, virtual gaming and Baweja saying dude.

That's the bad news. The good news is *Love Story 2050* went head-to-head with the Rs 10-crore *Jaane Tu Ya Jaane Na* (JTYJN)—featuring the boy next door falling in love with his best friend (female, of course)—and came out looking jaded. In contrast, JTYJN's hero doesn't have a mobile (he will get one when he gets a job), no car (his best friend drops him home after college) and shares breakfast duty with his mother (his father is dead, but speaks from a picture on the wall). Played by US-born debutant Imran Khan (actor Aamir Khan's nephew), this young man seems a natural—he's even genetically-blessed with a pout.

Imran's debut vehicle has been as cleverly put together as Harman's, with as much help from family, only it's with a keener ear to the ground. Written and directed by Abbas Tyrewala, it has benefited from the expertise of Imran's uncles, Aamir and director Mansoor Khan. Mansoor, who directed *Qayamat Se Qayamat Tak* (QSQT) and *Joh Jeeta*